

Ao Bara Co., Ltd. (青薔薇株式会社) — Research Report

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Date: 2026-05-29
Context: Due diligence on the selected operator for the Former Mitsue Elementary School Utilization Project

1. The Selection

On **January 27, 2026**, Mitsue Village (御杖村, Nara Prefecture) announced the result of its open-call proposal process for the reuse of the former Mitsue Elementary School building. Three companies submitted proposals. Ao Bara Co., Ltd. was selected as the **priority negotiating party** with a score of **894 out of 1,350 points** — significantly ahead of the two other applicants (647 and 622).

Applicant	Total (max 1,350)	General Business (450)	Utilization Plan (630)	Regional Revitalization (180)	Rent Proposal (90)
Ao Bara Co., Ltd. (selected)	894	297	413	103	81
Applicant A	647	181	304	72	90
Applicant B	622	187	272	82	81

Ao Bara's winning margin came almost entirely from the **Utilization Plan** category (413 vs. 304 and 272) — the highest-weighted criterion — suggesting a detailed and specific concept for the building. Notably, they did not offer the highest rent, indicating the proposal focused on use quality over financial return.

No runner-up was designated. As of May 2026, the village states that **full details of the business plan will be disclosed after contract negotiations are concluded.**

2. The Company

Field	Detail
Company name	青薔薇株式会社 (Ao Bara Co., Ltd. / BLUEROSE Inc.)
Corporate number	3190001028580
Address	103-17 Kawai, Iga City, Mie Prefecture 〒518-1315
Founded	August 2021

Field	Detail
Status	Private (unlisted)
Representative Director	森田浩次 (Koji Morita)
Website	https://bluerosepool.com
Email	bluerose.pool@gmail.com
Phone	090-6351-0027 (10:00–18:00, weekdays)

The company underwent a **name or registration update in August 2024** per the gBizINFO corporate database. No patents, certifications, or government subsidies are on public record.

What the company does

Ao Bara Co., Ltd. operates in the **professional billiards industry** under the brand name BLUEROSE. Their stated mission is *"bringing innovation to the billiards industry."* Their three main activities are:

1. **Tournament organisation** — hosting professional billiards competitions featuring top Japanese and Korean players
2. **App development** — building a billiards app ("BLUE ROSE") for player-shop matchmaking, ratings, and scoring
3. **Community building** — connecting billiards shops, players, and sponsors across Japan

Koji Morita — who is he?

Morita is an **active participant in the Japanese billiards community**, not merely a businessperson. He appears in the professional billiards player database (ビリヲカ / Billi-Walker) with a recorded match from March 2023 — competing in a JPBA-sanctioned tournament qualifier (lost 1–8 to ranked pro Kawabata Satoru in the Best 64 round). This confirms he is a genuine billiards player, not a front figure.

Tournament track record

Ao Bara ran the inaugural **BLUEROSE CUP** in March 2025 — a Japan–Korea women's billiards team tournament held in Osaka at the venue "DRAGON." Key facts:

- Formally supported and co-organised with the **JPBA (Japan Professional Pocket Billiard Association)**
- JPBA pro **Kawabata Satoru** appointed as Japan team coach
- Prize pool: **¥1.2 million** to the winning team
- Format: singles, doubles, trios, and 6v6 team matches; first to 7 wins takes the championship
- Billed as the first Japan–Korea billiards women's team competition in history

The **2nd BLUEROSE CUP** is scheduled for **January 17–18, 2026** at Yokohama POOL LABO — confirming this is an ongoing, growing series.

3. The Building

The former Mitsue Elementary School is an architecturally notable structure:

- **Architect:** Aoki Jun (青木淳) — a significant name in contemporary Japanese architecture
- **Main feature:** A dome building with a **spiral slab framework**, interior diameter **36m**, exterior max **57m**
- **History:** Consolidated from three smaller village schools on April 1, 1996; operated until **September 2021** when it merged with the middle school due to extreme rural depopulation (only 19 students in six grades at closure)
- **Heritage status:** Listed in the Agency for Cultural Affairs' modern cultural heritage database
- After closure, the campus temporarily housed the village library

The building's large, distinctive dome interior is a rare asset for a rural location — and an obvious candidate for a billiards hall or event/tournament venue.

4. Why the Plans Fit

The connection between Ao Bara's business and the school building is coherent:

- The dome's **36m interior diameter** provides ample open floor space for multiple billiards tables and spectator seating
 - Ao Bara is already running **national-level tournaments** and needs a dedicated venue
 - A permanent base in Nara would give the BLUEROSE brand a home — differentiated from generic rented halls in Osaka or Yokohama
 - The school's **distinctive architecture** would make the venue a destination attraction in its own right
 - A billiards academy, training centre, and event venue in rural Nara addresses the village's **regional revitalization** goals by drawing visitors
 - The company was **founded the same month the school closed** (August/September 2021), suggesting Morita may have had awareness of the opportunity early
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5. Organised Crime Assessment

This question is reasonable given the **historical association between billiards halls and yakuza in Japan (1960s–80s)**. The assessment based on available evidence is:

No indicators of organised crime connection found.

Specific reasons:

- Morita is a **documented billiards player** in legitimate JPBA-affiliated tournaments
- The **JPBA formally co-organised** the BLUEROSE CUP — professional sports bodies conduct their own anti-social forces screening and would not lend their name to a connected entity
- The **village's public procurement process** legally requires all applicants to declare non-affiliation with anti-social forces (反社会的勢力). This is standard in all Japanese public tenders
- The company holds a proper **invoice registration number** and appears in the national corporate

registry

- The 2nd BLUEROSE CUP is held at **Yokohama POOL LABO**, a mainstream established venue — not a grey-area establishment
- Direct searches combining the company name and yakuza/anti-social forces terms returned no relevant results

The billiards industry in Japan has been professionalised for decades through the JPBA and associated bodies. The historical stigma is largely outdated.

6. Potential Collaboration — Subrenting a Room

The Mitsue Village AI Data Center project could explore co-occupying the former school building. Key considerations:

In favour

- The school has multiple spaces (classrooms, gym, ancillary rooms) that a billiards operator would not need full-time
- A **complementary tenant** (quiet tech/office use vs. events/sport) suits both parties — Ao Bara gets predictable rental income; the AI data center gets a presence in Mitsue
- Having an additional anchor tenant strengthens Ao Bara's own **regional revitalization narrative** with the village
- It provides the AI data center project a physical foothold in the village before a purpose-built facility is constructed

Complications

- **Ao Bara has not yet signed the lease.** Negotiations are ongoing — there is no sublease to negotiate yet
- Japanese public facility leases almost always **require the landowner's (village's) explicit consent for any subletting**. Village approval is required, not just Ao Bara's agreement
- The building's **power and cooling infrastructure** is school-grade; unsuitable for server hardware without upgrades, though fine for office/meeting use
- **Rural connectivity** (fiber availability in Mitsue) would need independent verification

Recommended path

1. **Contact Mitsue Village Policy Promotion Division first** (0745-95-2001, ext. 240–241) — express interest in co-occupying the building. The village would welcome it and could build the arrangement into the lease agreement from the start
 2. Once the lease is signed, approach **Koji Morita directly** — a warm introduction via the village is far more effective than cold outreach
 3. Frame any proposal around **adding to regional revitalization**, not just requesting space
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7. Sources

- [旧御杖小学校利活用事業 — Mitsue Village official page](#)
- [BLUEROSE official website](#)
- [BLUEROSE CUP 1st tournament — Billiards Days](#)
- [BLUEROSE CUP 2nd tournament announcement — Billiards Days](#)
- [Japan-Korea match coverage — Web CUE'S](#)
- [JPBA press release on BLUEROSE CUP](#)
- [森田浩次 match record — ビリヲカ](#)
- [青薔薇株式会社 — gBizINFO corporate registry](#)
- [御杖村立御杖小学校 — Wikipedia](#)
- [御杖小学校 建築 — AOKI JUN WORKS](#)